WRW

ISSUE 01
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FRANCHISE ENTRY REPORT

Norway

Where the opportunity is, what blocks it, and what to do in the first 90 days.

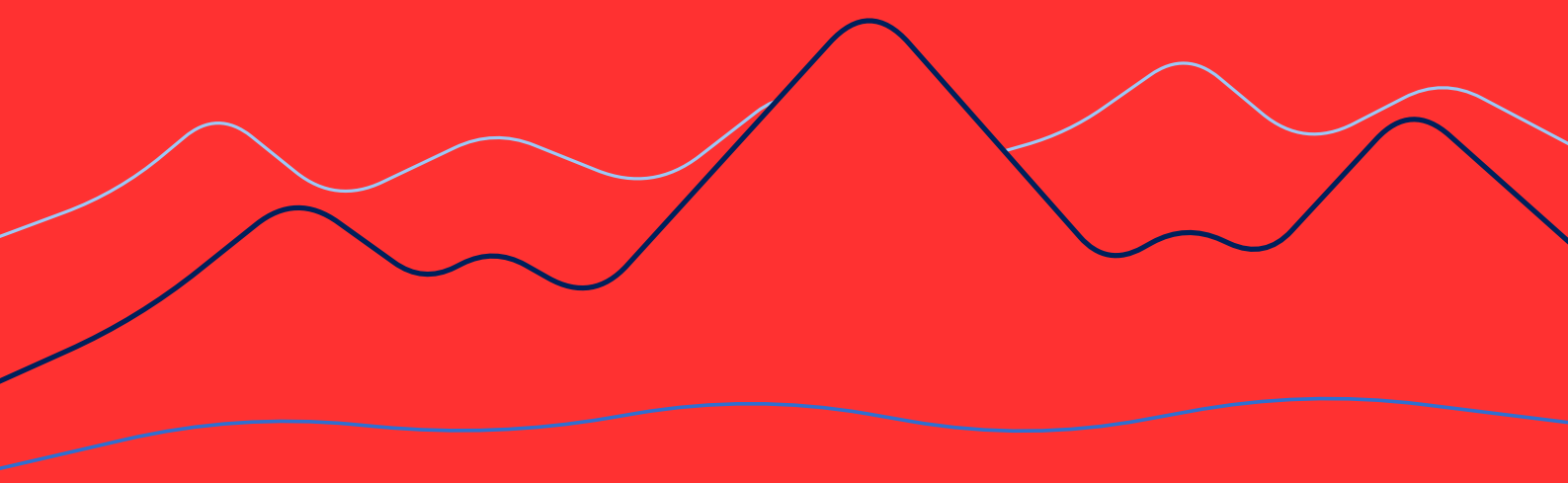
THE VERDICT

Open, but not easy. Burgers are taken and legacy pizza is retreating. Chicken is the live window, and it narrows once KFC arrives, expected from 2027.

5.64m
people, among Europe's highest incomes

+40%
restaurant prices above the EU average

0
franchise-specific laws or disclosure rules



02 MARKET SNAPSHOT

Rich, small and expensive, and it eats out less than you'd expect

Norway has the spending power. What it lacks is eating-out frequency. The brands that win here sell value per visit and convenience, not the special occasion.

POPULATION

5.64m

Measured at 1 July 2026, up from 5.59m at the end of 2024. Small by EU standards, so plan for a national footprint rather than a single city.

SSB, published 19 Aug 2026 [S1]

GDP PER HEAD

NOK 932,583

The 2024 figure. SSB puts it 63% above the EU average after adjusting for prices. Oil wealth inflates the total; mainland output grew 1.8% in 2025.

SSB [S2] · NOU 2026:5 [S5]

FOOD-SERVICE SPEND

NOK 146bn

Household spend on restaurants and accommodation in 2025, up 3.9% in volume. Food and drink serving alone accounted for NOK 104bn in 2023.

SSB table 14656 [S3]

FRANCHISE COUNT

Not found

There is no public official count. The last government estimate, from 2011, was c. 300 systems and c. 25,000 franchisees. Virke sells a paid industry report.

Stortinget answer, 2018 [S4] · Virke [S62]

CONSUMER SPENDING

+2.7%

Real household consumption growth in 2025. Confidence is still negative at −16.6 (Q3 2026), and restaurant and hotel prices are rising 6.0% a year, against 3.4% for everything.

NOU 2026:5 [S5] · Finans Norge [S6] · SSB CPI Sep 2026 [S11]

CURRENCY · NOK

£1 = NOK 12.52

€1 = NOK 10.49 and $1 = NOK 9.36 on 22 Oct 2026. Norges Bank raised the policy rate to 4.50% in September 2026 and says it may go higher.

Norges Bank [S7, S8]

How Norway eats out

Three facts that shape every unit P&L

HOW OFTEN · RARELY

7%

eat out weekly, and around half do so less than once a month. The packed lunch (matpakke) still beats the lunch counter.

[S9, S13]

AT WHAT PRICE · EXPENSIVELY

+40%

Restaurant and hotel prices sat 40% above the EU average in 2024, and they are rising almost twice as fast as general inflation.

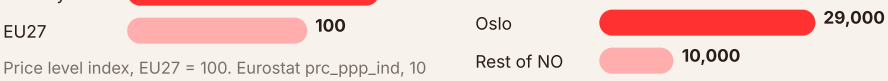


Price level index, EU27 = 100. Eurostat prc_ppp_ind, 10 Jul 2025 [S10, S11]

WHERE · IN OSLO

NOK 29,000

spent per head eating out by Oslo residents, against about NOK 10,000 in the rest of the country. Oslo alone has 2,919 food-service outlets.



NOK per head, approximate as published. Menon Economics for NHO Reiseliv, Jun 2025 [S12, S14]

So what?

Margins are thin, at 2–3% EBIT across the sector in 2023–24, and visits are rationed. A concept that needs frequent, impulse visits to break even will struggle. One that earns a full basket per visit, or sits on a route people already travel, has room. [S12]

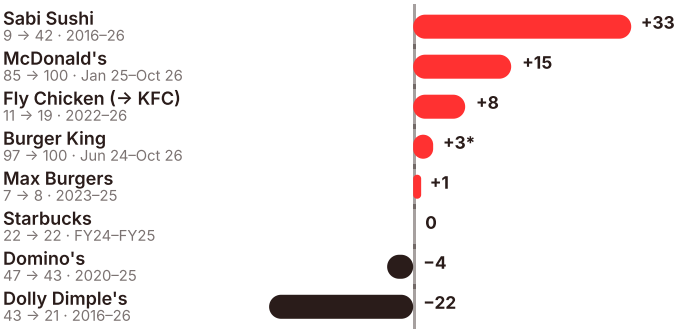
Burgers and chicken are growing. Legacy pizza is shrinking and coffee is flat.

A rise or fall call needs two independent signals. Where we found only one, the row is marked Thin. Unit counts come from brand locators (counted 23 Oct 2026) or the dated source shown.

CATEGORY	DIRECTION	EVIDENCE	SOURCE · WINDOW	CONFIDENCE	SATURATION	ENTRY
Chicken	↑ Rising	Fly Chicken grew from 11 to 19 sites. Apollo Group (KFC franchisee) agreed to buy it and convert most sites to KFC, with €20m over 5 years; the deal is subject to approvals. No other international chicken chain found.	S35, S36, S61 2022 → Aug 2026	Medium	Low	Medium
Burger	↑ Rising	McDonald's grew from 85 to 100 sites, with 7 more planned for 2026. Burger King went from 97 to "over 100".	S37–S40 Jan 2025 → Oct 2026	High	High	High
Pizza Legacy chains	↓ Falling	Domino's fell from 47 to 43 sites and was loss-making in 2023 and 2024. Dolly Dimple's fell from 43 to 21 and is now out of Oslo. Against this, Peppes plans 50 new franchised sites and Pizzabakeren claims 200.	S41–S45 2016 → Oct 2026	Medium	High	High
Kebab / grill	↑ Rising	Jafs grew from 54 to "over 60"; Big Bite from 53 to "over 70". Current figures are brand claims, not counts.	S46, S47 2016 → Jul 2026	Thin	Medium	Medium
Coffee	→ Flat	Starbucks held at 22 sites. Espresso House revenue was flat at NOK 499–516m (2023–25). Waynes Coffee's Swedish parent went bankrupt in Jul 2026.	S48–S50 2023 → Jul 2026	High	High	High
Bakery / dessert	Not found	No trend data. Backstube lists 45 Norwegian units (undated). No international doughnut or dessert-parlour chain found.	S48 Undated	Thin	Low	Medium
Bubble tea	Not found	Independents and micro-chains only (Oslo, Bergen). No international chain found.	S56 Oct 2026	Thin	Low	Low
Fast casual	↑ Rising	Sabi Sushi grew from 9 to 42 sites and now reaches as far north as Tromsø. Subway appointed a new Nordic master franchisee in 2025, targeting 250 Nordic sites by 2032.	S51–S53 2016 → Oct 2026	Medium	Medium	Medium
Plant-based	↓ Falling	Grocery sales of meat alternatives peaked in 2021 and fell back to 2020 levels. No plant-based restaurant chain found.	S54 Nov 2025	Thin	Low	High
Roadside Local category	↑ Rising	McDonald's signed a roadside deal with the Esso network for 7 sites; its 100th site is on the E16. Commercial overnight stays hit a record 40.6m in 2025 (+5.2%).	S37, S38, S57 Jan 2025 → Oct 2026	Medium	Medium	Medium

Change in unit count, selected chains

Units added or lost over the window shown. Windows differ, so compare direction, not size.



*Lower bound: brand says "over 100". Sources: brand locators counted 23 Oct 2026 (Sabi, Dolly Dimple's); brand releases, filings and press [S35–S45, S49, S51, S52].

READING THE TABLE

Growth follows the national operator

The growth is going to brands with a **national operator behind them**: McDonald's (14 franchisees), Burger King (King Food), and now KFC (Apollo Group).

Pizza is not dying. It is **consolidating** around the two domestic leaders, while weaker and international pizza brands lose ground.

Coffee is **full**. Starbucks has stood still, and convenience chains sell coffee at scale: Reitan runs 310 stores and Circle K 253. [S55]

04 WHITE-SPACE OPPORTUNITIES

Four gaps worth a closer look, and one has a deadline

A gap is a need with growing demand and no clear owner. The size of each one is our judgement of the prize for a new entrant: S, M or L.

1 The second chicken brand

GAP We found one sizeable chicken chain, and it is being turned into KFC. KFC takes the first rung; nobody holds the second.

EVIDENCE Fly Chicken grew from 11 to 19 sites. The first KFC openings are expected in early 2027, per Fly Chicken's founder. No Popeyes, Wingstop or similar found. [S35, S36, S61]

SUITS International chicken brands with multi-country franchise systems.

ROUTE Master franchise with a Nordic multi-brand operator.

L **Window:** before KFC scales, 2027–28

2 Roadside and forecourt QSR

GAP Long drives, record tourism, and fuel networks hunting for food partners.

EVIDENCE McDonald's signed with Esso for 7 sites, and its 100th site is on the E16. Commercial overnight stays reached 40.6m in 2025, with foreign stays at 14%. [S37, S38, S57]

SUITS Small-box and drive-thru formats with a fast, simple menu.

ROUTE Area developer, or a partnership with a fuel or convenience operator.

M Medium prize

3 Fast casual beyond Oslo

GAP Regional towns, where a branded unit can work on a small catchment.

EVIDENCE Sabi Sushi grew from 9 to 42 sites, including Tromsø and Bodø. Pizzabakeren runs 200 sites on a catchment of 6,000–8,000 people. [S44, S51, S52]

SUITS Compact, low-labour fast-casual concepts with a franchise-ready manual.

ROUTE Area developer by region.

M Medium prize

4 Bubble tea and treat drinks

GAP A trend category with independents but no branded chain.

EVIDENCE Only independents and micro-chains found, and no international chain present. Demand data: Not found. [S56]

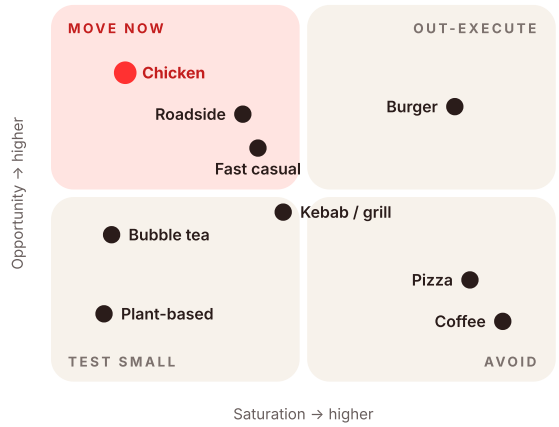
SUITS Low-capex kiosk and in-mall formats.

ROUTE Master franchise, or direct franchise with one strong Oslo partner.

S Small prize · Thin evidence

Opportunity vs saturation

Our assessment from the page 3 evidence. Position is judgement, not measurement.



Bakery and dessert are left off: too little data to place. Source: WRW Hospitality analysis of S35–S57.

IF I HAD A BRAND

> **If I ran an international chicken brand right now, I'd be in a Norwegian master-franchise conversation this quarter.**

KFC's first conversions are expected in early 2027. Once it has scaled, the market will have a clear first rung and room for one challenger. The second brand in will hold that rung. The tenth will be fighting for space.

If I ran a pizza or coffee brand, I'd look elsewhere. Those categories are full, and the weaker chains are already losing sites.

Wesley Williams, WRW Hospitality

05 REGULATION AND COST TO OPERATE

No franchise law, a firm wage floor, and a trade mark you must file separately

Norway is easy to enter on paper and expensive to run in practice. Your contract does all the protecting, so write it well. Your labour model does most of the damage, so test it first.

AREA	CURRENT POSITION (VERIFIED OCT 2026)	SOURCE
Franchise law	**None.** There is no franchise-specific law, mandatory disclosure or registration. General contract, marketing and competition law apply. We found no proposals for change in 2024–26.	S15, S16
Trade mark	File with Patentstyret: NOK 3,800 including one class, then NOK 1,000 per extra class. Allow about 3 weeks to 4 months. **An EU trade mark does not cover Norway.** The Madrid route is available.	S17
Food safety	Register with Mattilsynet before opening. Inspection "smiley" reports must be posted at the entrance.	S18
Alcohol	Two municipal licences (serving and skjenkebevilling), with character checks, granted for up to 4 years. An annual fee is charged by volume; the Oslo minimum is NOK 6,600.	S19, S20
Halal	No state certification. Stunning before slaughter is mandatory, so non-stunned halal meat is imported under a 150-tonne yearly tariff quota.	S21, S22
Tax	VAT is 15% on takeaway food and 25% eaten in. Corporate tax is 22%. No withholding tax on royalties to an unrelated franchisor (15% applies only to related parties in low-tax countries).	S23–S25
Company	An AS needs NOK 30,000 share capital. The general manager and half the board must live in the EEA (the UK is accepted).	S26, S27

TRADE MARK FILING

NOK 3,800

Patentstyret fee including one class. Your EU mark does not reach Norway. [S17]

VAT, TAKEAWAY VS EAT-IN

15% vs 25%

Set the channel mix early: it moves the price on every ticket. [S23]

WITHHOLDING ON ROYALTIES

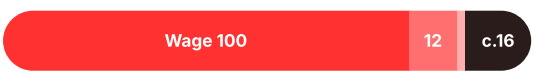
None

For an unrelated franchisor. 15% applies only to related parties in low-tax countries. [S25]

THE WAGE ENGINE

Model the unit at Norwegian wages before you model the royalty

What every NOK 100 of pay costs the employer



Wage 100 · Holiday pay 12 · Pension 2 · Employer NI c.16 · **Total ≈ 130**

ESTIMATE 12% holiday pay (5-week agreement; 10.2% statutory), 2% minimum pension, and 14.1% employer NI (zone I) on pay, holiday pay and pension. Excludes the 16 days of employer-paid sick leave. [S28–S32]

LEGAL WAGE FLOOR

NOK 204.79

Per hour, hospitality, over-20 entry rate, from 15 Jun 2025. The collective agreement rate is NOK 227.17 from 1 Jun 2026.

[S33, S34]

ALL-IN FLOOR

≈ £21/hr

ESTIMATE NOK 204.79 × 1.3 ≈ NOK 266 an hour, converted at £1 = NOK 12.52.

[S7, S33]

Not legal or tax advice. Confirm the position with a Norwegian adviser before signing.

06 ENTRY ROUTE AND RISKS

Pick the route that fits your size. Then price the risk.

Each route trades control against capital and speed. The examples below show how brands have actually come into Norway.

ROUTE	YOUR CONTROL	YOUR CAPITAL	SPEED TO SCALE	SEEN IN NORWAY
Master franchise	Low	Low	Fast	KFC via Apollo Group with MM Group (2026). Subway via Nordic Bites Group (2025). Starbucks via Dely. [S35, S48, S53]
Area developer	Medium	Low	Medium	Burger King under King Food, which took control of a large franchisee in 2025. [S38]
Direct franchise	High	Medium	Slow	Domestic chains growing this way: Sabi Sushi, Pizzabakeren, Peppes. Hard to support from abroad. [S44, S45, S51]
Company-owned launch	Full	High	Slow	Max Burgers: 7 units in 2023, 8 in 2025. UK chain Leon left in 2021 after 2 sites. [S49, S50]

EMERGING BRAND

Master franchise

Under c. 25 units and no overseas track record. A Norwegian multi-site operator brings the wage, licence and property know-how you can't buy remotely.

MID-SIZE BRAND

Area developer by region

Proven in 2 countries. Split Oslo and the west coast and keep control of standards. The domestic leaders all scale through local owners.

GLOBAL BRAND

Nordic master partner

Every recent international entry in our data runs through a regional multi-brand operator. Back a partner who can take Norway and its neighbours.

Price the risk before you price the franchise

Six risks, each sourced

COSTS AND DEMAND

Restaurant prices are up 6.0% a year and sector margins are 2–3%. Only 17% of operators call the market good (Oct 2026). Food-service bankruptcies were 87 in Q3 2026, down 9%. [S11, S12, S58, S59]

LABOUR

A legal hospitality wage floor of NOK 204.79 an hour and about 30% on-costs. Model the unit at Norwegian wages before you model the royalty. [S33]

SUPPLY CHAIN

Norway is outside the EU customs union, and farm imports run on tariff quotas. Plan local meat and dairy; non-stunned halal is capped at 150 tonnes a year. [S22]

SEASONALITY

Summer and tourist routes peak hard: 40.6m commercial overnight stays in 2025, with foreign stays at 14%. Flex labour and site mix to match. [S57]

REGULATORY

With no franchise law, your contract carries all the protection. Alcohol licences are local and discretionary. Single-use plastics are banned, and packaging duties apply. [S15, S19, S60]

CURRENCY AND RATES

Royalties are earned in NOK. The policy rate is 4.50% and may rise, which squeezes franchisee borrowing for fit-outs. [S7, S8]

07 YOUR FIRST 90 DAYS

Ten moves, in order, before you sign anything

1. **File your trade mark** with Patentstyret now. Your EU mark does not cover Norway.
2. **Search Patentstyret and Brønnøysund** for clashing names before you spend on a launch.
3. **Rebuild the unit P&L** at Norwegian wages, with about 30% on-costs.
4. **Set the takeaway and eat-in mix** early: 15% VAT vs 25%.
5. **Shortlist 3 to 5 Nordic multi-brand operators** as master or area partners.
6. **Prepare a full disclosure pack** anyway. No law requires one, but serious partners will expect it.
7. **Map local supply** for meat and dairy, including halal and import quotas.
8. **Choose your first cluster:** Oslo for spend, or one regional city for lower rents.
9. **Plan the licence path:** Mattilsynet registration, plus alcohol licences if needed.
10. **Agree how royalties are paid** and hedged in NOK.

WHAT WE'D CHECK NEXT

- Current franchise counts in Virke's paid franchise report
- Food-delivery data for 2025–26 by category
- Live unit counts for Espresso House, Peppes, Joe & The Juice and Subway
- Any 2026 update to the hospitality wage floor
- Rents and fit-out costs by city

METHOD

Public sources only, accessed 21–23 Oct 2026. Every figure is dated and coded to the list below. Rise and fall calls need two independent signals; otherwise they are marked Thin. Estimates are labelled with their method. Missing data is shown as Not found. Not legal, tax or investment advice.

Sources

62 public sources · accessed 21–23 Oct 2026

S1 SSB, Population (folketal), 19 Aug 2026
S2 SSB, GDP per capita (table 09842); Norsk økonomi fact page
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S4 Stortinget, written answer 15:1599, 28 May 2018
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S9 NHO Reiseliv, Gallup on eating out, 27 Oct 2025
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S14 SSB, Food service by city (table 08039), 2024
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S19 Helsedirektoratet, licence types, 18 Sep 2026
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S24 PwC Tax Summaries, Norway corporate tax, 25 Jun 2026
S25 Skatteetaten, withholding tax on royalties
S26 Brønnøysund fees; Commenda, AS share capital, 9 Apr 2026
S27 Revisjon og Regnskap 5/2021, residency rule
S28 Skatteetaten, employer NI rates 2026
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S35 Verdict Foodservice, Apollo Group to acquire Fly Chicken, 27 Jul 2026
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S37 McDonald's Norge, restaurant no. 100, 6 Oct 2026
S38 McDonald's Norge, Esso agreement, 24 Jan 2025; Konkurransetilsynet, King Food/Burger Venture, Aug 2025
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S43 Dolly Dimple's restaurant list, counted 23 Oct 2026; Bakeri.net, 3 Apr 2016
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S45 E24, Peppes Pizza plans 50 new restaurants, 2 Nov 2025
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S51 Sabi Sushi restaurant list, counted 23 Oct 2026
S52 Gjesdal kommune, Sabi Sushi document, 25 Mar 2016
S53 Subway Newsroom, Nordic Bites Group, 20 May 2025
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S62 Virke, Franchiserapporten (paid report), 2025

Which country should we cover next?

Tell us in the comments. Follow WRW Hospitality for the next Franchise Entry Report, every Friday.

WRW Hospitality · Wesley Williams